



## Karl Petzold

### Creative Director, UI/UX, AI Creative

*Senior Art & Creative Director based in Paris, I shape defining brand projects across experience and interface design, brand strategy, and campaigns. My work spans leading global brands in luxury, entertainment, and other industries where creative excellence is non-negotiable.*

*Deeply passionate about AI and entertainment, I'm convinced Mistral will play a defining role in the future of AI and its place in people's lives. That conviction is precisely why I'm reaching out: to bring my experience, perspective, and creative ambition to Mistral as Creative Director.*

## Skills

### AI CREATIVE

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I started exploring AI early, running diffusion models locally before the technology reached a wider audience. I later co-built and now lead Pavillon Noir's AI practice, training 300+ professionals, delivering fully AI-driven campaigns for *Dior* and *Rabanne*, and building the agency's internal AI knowledge engine, while continuously developing my own experiments and projects.

### UI/UX

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I built my early career as a UI/UX designer across a wide range of projects, including for *Blizzard Entertainment*, developing strong expertise across desktop and mobile web, as well as iOS and Android apps. This hands-on experience gave me a deep understanding of user behavior, expectations, and audience engagement.

### ART DIRECTION

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An Art Director for over 15 years, I co-created *Asphalte*, worked on every *Blizzard* franchise launch between 2014 and 2020, and led EMEA campaigns for publishers including *Activision*, *Ubisoft*, and *Tencent*. I have also helped brands such as *Von Dutch* and *Salomon* roll out innovative experiences, and most recently led the full rebrand of venture capital firm *Singular*.

### PHOTO, VIDEO, MUSIC

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Over the years, I've devoted much of my free time to photography, filmmaking, music, and creative technology, building a broad hands-on practice that continually feeds both my personal and professional work.

# Experience

## HEAD OF GAMING & AI

[Pavillon Noir](#)  
2022 - Current

I joined *Pavillon Noir* in 2022 to lead its gaming portfolio, overseeing global and EMEA launches for *Activision*, *Ubisoft*, *Tencent*, *EA*, *Riot Games*, *Epic Games*, *Team Vitality*, and the *Esports World Cup*.

In parallel, I've co-built the agency's AI practice, training creative, marketing, and design teams at *Puig*, *Dacia*, *Dior*, and *Mazarine*, while leading hybrid and fully AI-produced campaigns for *Dior*, *Rabanne*, and *Benetton*.

Over the past six months, I've been building the agency's internal AI infrastructure through extensive R&D on frontier models, streamlining workflows across operations, legal, strategy, and creative, already saving significant time and helping win pitches on exceptionally short timelines.

## ART DIRECTOR

[L'École des Loisirs](#)  
2020 - 2022

I worked as a UI/UX and brand designer for *L'École des loisirs*, notably on its reading platform for 15-18 year olds.

## INTERACTION DESIGNER

[Blizzard Entertainment](#)  
2014 - 2020

Six years as an Interaction Designer at *Blizzard Entertainment*, working within the Digital Marketing team across UI/UX, eCRM campaigns, visual design, and motion design.

Additional experience included training with Blizzard's HQ Mobile team on mobile UI/UX and presenting global focus-group research directly to the *Hearthstone* game team.

## CO-FOUNDER/ART DIRECTOR

[Asphalte](#)  
2017 - 2020

Co-founder of *Asphalte*, responsible for building the brand from the ground up, from its name, visual identity, and website to tone of voice, product naming, social presence, and communications. This cohesive brand system helped *Asphalte* quickly establish itself as a distinctive name in French menswear.

## FASHION PHOTOGRAPHER

[Repetto / Six&Sept](#)  
2012 - 2018

Self-taught photographer, I quickly began working with fashion brands, starting with *Repetto* on the lookbook and product imagery for its first ready-to-wear collection.

I later collaborated with *Pictoresq*, a French creative duo known for its cinematic and literary approach to fashion storytelling, before working with brands including *Six&Sept*, *Ann Tuij*, and *José* across photography, video, and motion design.

## MUSIC LABEL OWNER

[Beyond The Line](#)  
2010 - 2014

Co-founded an independent music label in 2010 to develop a personal vision of techno and house music. The project combined event production, international underground bookings, DJ performances, and full creative direction of the label's identity, including posters and digital campaign assets.

# Education

## MASTER DIRECTION ARTISTIQUE

Equivalent to M.S. in Art Direction  
2012 - Paris XV<sup>e</sup>

## BTS COMMUNICATION VISUELLE

Two years Technical Degree in Visual Communication  
2009 - Paris XIX<sup>e</sup>

## LICENCE PROFESSIONNELLE

Third year University Degree in Design Project Management  
2011 - Marne-La-Vallée

## BAC STI ARTS APPLIQUÉS

French Secondary School Degree in Applied Arts  
2007 - Bondy

[ONLINE PORTFOLIO](#)

[PETZOLD.KARL@GMAIL.COM](mailto:PETZOLD.KARL@GMAIL.COM)

+33 (0)682263086